

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

STOP TELLING BUYERS TO WAIVE THE INSPECTION.

It's still not what most buyers do. There's a better middle move.

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**1 IN 5 BUYERS
ACTUALLY WAIVE
THE INSPECTION
CONTINGENCY.**

That's up from last month. It's still the minority, not the norm.

THERE'S A VERSION BETWEEN "WAIVE IT" AND "KEEP IT."

NAR's REALTORS Confidence Index for August 2026 puts the real number at 20 percent of buyers waiving the inspection contingency outright, up from 16 percent the month before and 18 percent a year before that. It's rising, but four in five buyers still keep some form of inspection protection. The binary most listing pitches present, waive it or lose the house, skips the option that actually protects a buyer without scaring off a seller: an information-only or pass-fail inspection. The buyer still gets eyes on the property and still walks from a real structural or safety issue. They just agree up front not to renegotiate over a cracked outlet cover or a loose cabinet hinge.

THE SWAP FOR THE NEXT OFFER:

- 1 Don't say "waive the inspection to look serious."**
Say "let's do an information-only inspection so you know what you're buying, without giving up leverage to renegotiate everything."
- 2 Don't delete the contingency. Shorten the window.**
Three days instead of ten still signals speed to the seller without stripping the buyer's protection entirely.
- 3 Reserve a true waiver for the buyer who can self-insure a five-figure surprise.**
Say that reason out loud, so it's a choice they're making, not pressure they're absorbing.

THE TAKEAWAY

A "CLEAN" OFFER ISN'T WORTH A CLIENT'S SAVINGS.

Give them the option that protects the offer and the buyer.